

Will Cygan

SOFTWARE ENGINEER WORKING ON PURCHASE AND PAYMENTS SYSTEMS AT LINKEDIN

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Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer

Chicago, IL

LINKEDIN

March 2024 - Present

- Architected a high-performance alerting system using Kafka, Samza, and Venice, enabling real-time invoice tracking and alerts at 50,000+ QPS for the LinkedIn Global Alerts feature.
- Reclaimed \$2M+ in annualized revenue by preventing involuntary churn through the Global Alerts system, contributing to bottom-line growth at LinkedIn and customer retention efforts.
- Engineered a Kusto-based exception summary dashboard, integrating access and application logs, reducing incident triage time from tens of minutes to seconds and enhancing overall efficiency.
- Led JVM optimization efforts using A/B testing to improve JVM health from 30-80% to 99.9% across unhealthy production services.

Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA

LINKEDIN

Feb 2022 - March 2024

- Contributed to the backend implementation of VYMBII (Videos You Might Be Interested In) for LinkedIn Learning courses on [linkedin.com/feed/](https://www.linkedin.com/feed/), serving videos at around 3,000 QPS.
- Leveraged ML models to personalize video recommendations for courses displayed in a carousel format similar to TikTok, resulting in a 10%+ increase in course engagement.
- Developed the offline flows (Spark+HDFS) for Learning Alerts, a recommendation system that classifies users based on job-seeking preferences and delivers targeted course recommendations to 10M users weekly.

Software Engineer Intern

San Francisco, CA

LINKEDIN

Winter 2020, Summer 2021

- Introduced new learning recommendations into the homepage feed for LinkedIn Learning.
- Built a course ranker to attract job seekers to LinkedIn Learning.
- Created a discovery experience on LinkedIn Learning.
- Leveraged the economic graph to discover relevant skills for job titles.

Projects

Anton (Kubernetes Homelab)

🌐 wcygan/anton

CLUSTER OPERATOR / TECHNICIAN

December 2024 - Present

- Constructed a 3-node Kubernetes control plane on Talos Linux, achieving a fault-tolerant, highly available cluster.
- Implemented zero-trust remote access via Cloudflare Tunnels and Tailscale, streamlining remote cluster management
- Deployed data infrastructure like TiDB, RedPanda, DragonflyDB, and ScyllaDB for experimentation & learning

tokio-utils Rust Library

🌐 wcygan/tokio-utils

MAINTAINER

March 2023 - Present

- Crafted a library for Asynchronous Rust which supports patterns like Rate Limiting, Object Pooling, and Graceful Shutdown
- Engineered a web crawler atop this library with rate limiting to ensure continuous data capture of internet graph data (similar to Google's PageRank) without triggering rate limits or IP blacklisting

Skills

Languages Java, Rust, Go, SQL, Python, Scala, Typescript, Bash

Technologies Temporal, gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Docker, Kubernetes, Talos Linux

Data Systems MySQL, Kafka, Flink, Beam, Spark, Hadoop, Hive, Trino, Kusto, Redis

Education

University of Illinois at Chicago

Chicago, IL

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

January 2018 - December 2021